

Romania's 3.1-Mile Recycled Table Sets World Record

From: DOGOnews Mined: 2026-10-03 5 min read

On September 12, 2026, about 20,000 people gathered in Bucharest, Romania, for a **community** meal at the "Uniting Table." Stretching 3.1 miles (4.99 kilometers), it set a new Guinness World Record for the longest table made from recycled materials.

The world record was just part of the goal. The event, organized by the nonprofit Bloom The World, also served as a **fundraiser**. It raised more than \$110,000 for Romania's first **psychiatric** hospital for children, a hospital providing mental health care.

Currently, children in Bucharest who need mental health care are treated in an **outdated** facility. It has large, crowded wards that lack basic **privacy**. The new hospital is scheduled to open in 2027 and provide care for children with conditions such as depression, autism, and ADHD.

This was the second time Bloom achieved this record. In 2025, the nonprofit brought together 10,000 people around a 1.7-mile (2.7-kilometer) table made from recycled materials. That event was held in Alba Iulia, Romania. It focused on bringing people together and raising **environmental** awareness.

Bloom plans to recycle the materials from its latest record-breaking table again. This time, they will be used to make children's furniture.

Word Treasure

community -- A group of people connected by a place or shared interests.

fundraiser -- An event or activity that collects money for a cause.

psychiatric -- Related to the treatment of mental health conditions.

outdated -- Old and no longer suited to current needs.

privacy -- Having personal space and control over what others can see or know.

environmental -- Related to the natural world and people's effects on it.

Break it down

Opens with the date, location, attendance, and world record.

Explains how the meal raised funds for a children's psychiatric hospital.

Describes the current facility and the hospital's planned opening.

Looks back at Bloom's 2025 record and its environmental focus.

Closes with the planned reuse of the latest table's materials.

Why it matters

The event connects a community celebration with funding for children's mental health care and a plan to recycle materials into furniture.

Test what you remember

1. How long was the Uniting Table in Bucharest?
 - (A) 1.7 miles
 - (B) 3.1 miles
 - (C) 2.7 miles
 - (D) 4.99 miles
2. Besides setting a record, what did the 2026 event do?
 - (A) Opened a new children's furniture shop
 - (B) Built a new community dining hall
 - (C) Launched a new hospital training program
 - (D) Raised money for a children's hospital
3. How much money did the event raise?
 - (A) More than \$110,000
 - (B) Less than \$110,000
 - (C) About \$20,000
 - (D) Exactly \$110,000
4. What problem does the article describe at the current care facility?
 - (A) Few classrooms with old furniture
 - (B) Narrow gardens with little shade
 - (C) Small kitchens with limited seating
 - (D) Crowded wards with little privacy
5. What did the 2025 event focus on?
 - (A) Furniture design and building skills
 - (B) Togetherness and environmental awareness
 - (C) Sports training and healthy meals
 - (D) Hospital care and medical research
6. Which statement describes Bloom's plan for the latest table?
 - (A) Recycle its materials into children's furniture
 - (B) Send it to Alba Iulia for another event
 - (C) Move it into the new hospital's wards
 - (D) Keep it standing for future community meals

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):